A PRAYER WORKBOOK

Shelter

30 Days in the Psalms of Trust

Thirty days of Scripture, prayer and one small practice, with room to write down what you notice along the way.

> *"Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me. Your rod and your staff, they comfort me."*
>
> **Psalm 23:4**

This workbook belongs to _____

I began on _____

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this workbook

Each day takes about ten minutes, at the kitchen table, before work or last thing at night. There is no wrong way to do it.

THE DAILY RHYTHM

1. **Read** the verse and the reflection, slowly.
2. **Pray** the day's prayer, aloud if you can.
3. **Declare** speak the declaration, then tick the box.
4. **Practice** one small, concrete step for the day.
5. **Check in** circle where your fear is, before and after you pray.
6. **Write** a few lines. A sentence is enough.

THE FEAR CHECK-IN

1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming. It isn't a score. It simply records where you are, so you can look back later and see what happened.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

IF YOU MISS A DAY

Pick up where you left off. Missing a day does not erase your progress.

LOOK BACK EACH WEEK

After Days 7, 14, 21 and 29 there is a page for looking back on the week, and after Day 30, one for the whole journey.

LISTEN ALONG

Every day can be read aloud to you in the Stand app, which is free and needs no account. Scan the code beside any day's title to open that day. This one opens the app.

KEEP IT PRIVATE

This workbook is yours. What you write here is for you, so keep it somewhere you trust.

THE JOURNEY AT A GLANCE

WEEK ONE · REFUGE	**Days 1–7**	Shelter · Shepherd · Refuge · Keeper · Shield · Rock · Silence
WEEK TWO · HONEST LAMENT	**Days 8–14**	How Long? · Brokenhearted · Waiting for Morning · When I Am Afraid · Every Tear · Higher Than I · My God, My God
WEEK THREE · RETRAINING TRUST	**Days 15–21**	Trust and Do Good · Be Still · A Quieted Soul · Fully Known · Cast Your Burden · My Times · A Steady Heart
WEEK FOUR · FROM FEAR TO PRAISE	**Days 22–29**	Delivered · Forget Not · Morning · Remember · A Firm Place to Stand · Tell the Next Generation · Sown in Tears · He Heard Me
DAY THIRTY · I SHALL NOT BE MOVED	**Day 30**	I Shall Not Be Moved

WHEN FEAR SPIKES

Steady me now

A ninety-second pause for when fear will not sit still. The same steps are one tap away in the app.

1. **Breathe.** In for four, hold for four, out for six. Three slow breaths. ◯ ◯ ◯
2. **Anchor.** *"The LORD is my light and my salvation. Whom shall I fear?"* **Psalm 27:1**
3. **Pray.** Lord, bring me back to this moment. Slow my heart, steady my breath, and stand with me here. I hand You what I cannot control.
4. **Declare.** Fear may speak, but it does not get the final word.
5. **Check in.** Steadier? If not, take another round. Whatever the next hour holds, this moment was faithfulness. Go gently.

Before (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

WHAT STEADIES ME

People I can call or text

A verse or phrase that steadies me

Something I can do with my hands or feet

If fear feels bigger than you can carry right now, you don't have to carry it alone:

- **988** — Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text, 24/7)
- Text **HOME** to **741741** — Crisis Text Line
- **1-800-799-7233** — National Domestic Violence Hotline (24/7; or text START to 88788)
- **1-800-422-4453** — Childhelp National Child Abuse Hotline (call or text, 24/7)
- **911** — if you are in immediate physical danger
- Outside the US: **findahelpline.com** — free, verified helplines in 175+ countries

Stand offers spiritual encouragement. It isn't medical or crisis care, and reaching out for more help is its own act of courage.

BEFORE DAY 1

Where are you right now?

What am I afraid of? Name it plainly.

WHERE IS MY FEAR TODAY? (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What am I hoping for in these thirty days?

Who is walking with me? (Initials are enough.)

WHEN I'LL PRAY EACH DAY _____ **WHERE** _____

AT A GLANCE

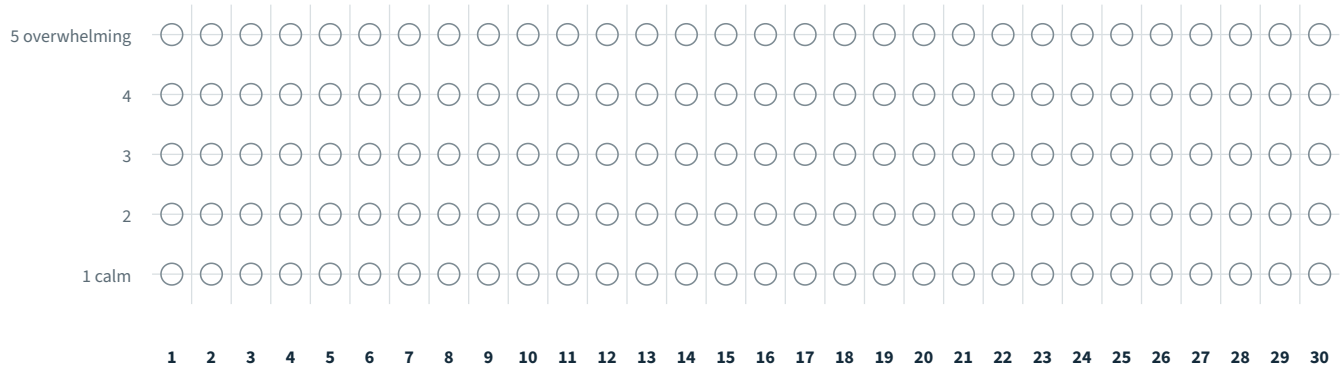
My thirty days

Tick each day as you go. Missing a day does not erase your progress.

1 Shelter ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	2 Shepherd ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	3 Refuge ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	4 Keeper ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	5 Shield ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	6 Rock ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE
7 Silence ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	8 How Long? ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	9 Brokenhearted ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	10 Waiting for Morning ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	11 When I Am Afraid ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	12 Every Tear ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE
13 Higher Than I ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	14 My God, My God ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	15 Trust and Do Good ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	16 Be Still ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	17 A Quieted Soul ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	18 Fully Known ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE
19 Cast Your Burden ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	20 My Times ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	21 A Steady Heart ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	22 Delivered ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	23 Forget Not ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	24 Morning ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE
25 Remember ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	26 A Firm Place to Stand ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	27 Tell the Next Generation ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	28 Sown in Tears ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	29 He Heard Me ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE	30 I Shall Not Be Moved ☐ PRAYED ☐ PRACTICE

WHERE MY FEAR WAS EACH DAY, BEFORE I PRAYED

Fill one circle a day.



Date _____

Shelter

Scan to listen to Day 1

> *"He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High will rest in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say of the LORD, "He is my refuge and my fortress; my God, in whom I trust.""*
>
> **Psalm 91:1–2**

REFLECTION

Fear tells you to become your own fortress: watchful, armored, never off duty. This psalm offers a different posture. Dwell near, and rest in a shadow you did not have to cast.

PRAYER

Most High, I have been trying to be my own shelter, and I am tired. Teach me to dwell near You, not only to visit when things are bad, but to stay. Let me say it aloud and mean it a little more each day: You are my refuge, and I trust You.

DECLARE

I do not have to be my own fortress.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Say verse 2 aloud, slowly. Notice which word is hardest to mean today (refuge, fortress, or trust) and write it in your notes.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Shepherd

Scan to listen to Day 2

> *"Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me. Your rod and your staff, they comfort me."*
>
> **Psalm 23:4**

REFLECTION

The psalm does not promise a way around the valley; it promises company through it. The reason given for not fearing is not that the valley is safe, but that you are not walking it alone.

PRAYER

Shepherd, I would rather skip this valley, and You know that. If I must walk through it, walk close enough that I can tell. Let Your nearness be louder than the shadows, and lead me one step at a time.

DECLARE

I am walking through this valley, and I am not walking alone.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Name the valley you are in with one plain sentence, without exaggerating or minimizing it. Then add four words: "and You are with me."

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Refuge

Scan to listen to Day 3



> *"God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble. Therefore we won't be afraid, though the earth changes, though the mountains are shaken into the heart of the seas."*
>
> **Psalm 46:1–2**

REFLECTION

"Very present" means help that is already here, not help that is on its way. The psalm faces the worst case directly, the ground itself moving, and places God inside it rather than after it.

PRAYER

God, things I counted on as solid have shifted. Be my refuge now, in the middle of the change, not only once it settles. Help me look for You in this hour instead of waiting for a better one.

DECLARE

Help is present, not pending.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

List what has shifted recently that felt like solid ground. Beside each, write one way God has been present in it. If you cannot find one yet, write "not yet." That is honest too.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Keeper

Scan to listen to Day 4

> *"I will lift up my eyes to the hills. Where does my help come from? My help comes from the LORD, who made heaven and earth."*
>
> **Psalm 121:1–2**

REFLECTION

The psalmist asks the question fear asks (where will help come from?) and does not pretend not to have asked it. The answer looks past the hills, past every visible source of rescue, to the One who made them.

PRAYER

Lord, I keep scanning the hills: people, plans, money, the next phone call. Today I lift my eyes higher. You made heaven and earth, and You can keep me. Let my help come from You first, and let every other help be a gift rather than a lifeline I clutch.

DECLARE

My help comes from the One who made the hills.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write down the "hills" you have been watching for rescue. Thank God for each as a possible gift, and place your hope above all of them.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Shield

Scan to listen to Day 5

> *"But you, the LORD, are a shield around me, my glory, and the one who lifts up my head."*
>
> **Psalm 3:3**

REFLECTION

Psalm 3 is headed as David's prayer while fleeing from his own son. Trouble surrounded him on every side, and so, he says, does God: a shield around him, not only in front. And when fear and shame bend a head down, God is the one who lifts it.

PRAYER

Lord, I feel exposed on every side. Be a shield around me, not only in front of me. Where fear and shame have bent my head down, lift it, gently, until I can look at today.

DECLARE

I am surrounded, and I am also shielded.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Notice your posture right now. Lift your head, let your shoulders drop, and pray verse 3 once, slowly, looking up.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Rock

Scan to listen to Day 6

> *"The LORD is my rock, my fortress, and my deliverer; my God, my rock, in whom I take refuge."*
>
> **Psalm 18:2**

REFLECTION

David piles up names because one is not enough to hold what God has been to him. Fear narrows your vocabulary to a single word: danger. Naming God widens it again.

PRAYER

My Rock, my fortress, my deliverer: I say Your names because my fear has only one word, and I need more than one. Be steady under me where everything else is moving. I take refuge in You today.

DECLARE

I stand on something that does not move.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write three names for God that have been true in your own life, not borrowed but remembered. Keep the list where you will see it tonight.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Silence

Scan to listen to Day 7

> *"My soul, wait in silence for God alone, for my expectation is from him. He alone is my rock and my salvation, my fortress. I will not be shaken."*
>
> **Psalm 62:5–6**

REFLECTION

David speaks to his own soul like a friend who needs settling. Silence here is not emptiness. It is the noise of rehearsing and bargaining set down, so you can wait for God alone rather than for every outcome at once.

PRAYER

God, my mind is crowded with rehearsed conversations and worst cases. For a few minutes I set them down. I wait for You alone. Let quiet become a place where I meet You, not a place I dread.

DECLARE

In the quiet, I am not alone.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Sit in silence for three minutes with a timer. When a worry speaks, answer it once with "for God alone," and return to the quiet. Afterward, write one word for how it went.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

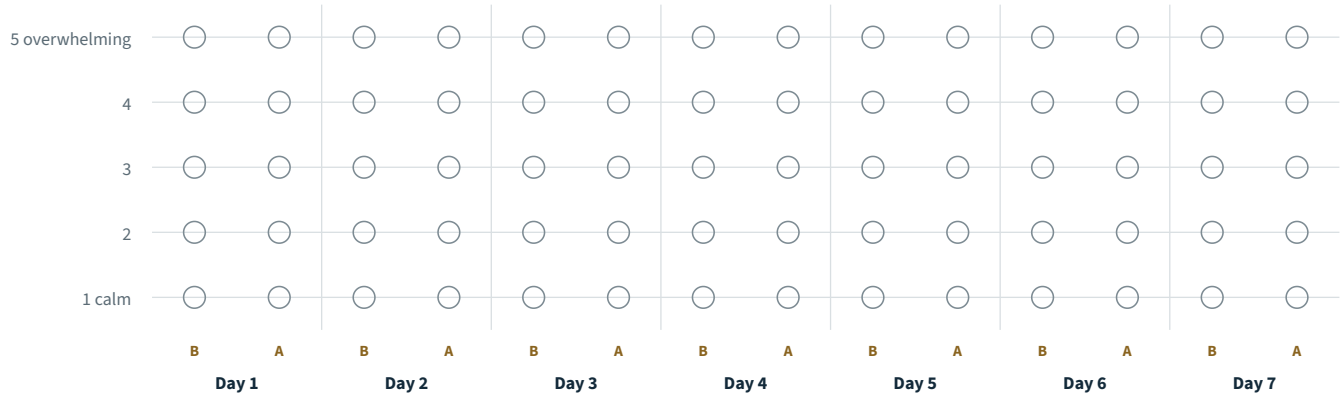
Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Looking back on week one

MY CHECK-INS, DAYS 1–7

For each day, fill the circle for your fear before (B) and after (A) you prayed.



THE DECLARATIONS

Circle the one you most want to keep.

- ○ **DAY 1** I do not have to be my own fortress.
- ○ **DAY 2** I am walking through this valley, and I am not walking alone.
- ○ **DAY 3** Help is present, not pending.
- ○ **DAY 4** My help comes from the One who made the hills.
- ○ **DAY 5** I am surrounded, and I am also shielded.
- ○ **DAY 6** I stand on something that does not move.
- ○ **DAY 7** In the quiet, I am not alone.

What shifted this week, even a little?

Where was it hardest?

What do I want to bring into next week?

Date _____

How Long?

Scan to listen to Day 8

> *"How long will you hide your face from me? How long shall I take counsel in my soul, having sorrow in my heart every day?"*
>
> **Psalm 13:1–2**

REFLECTION

David asks "how long" four times in two verses, and the psalm keeps every one of them. Complaint addressed to God is still faith; it assumes Someone is listening. By verse 5 he is trusting again, but he does not get there by skipping the questions.

PRAYER

Lord, I have carried this a long time, and I am tired of being brave about it. How long? I am asking You, not walking away from You. Hear the question, and stay with me while I wait for the answer.

DECLARE

Asking God "how long" is still talking to God.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write your own "How long…?" lines, as many as are true, with nothing softened. Beneath them, write one line that begins with "But." If you cannot write it yet, leave the space.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Brokenhearted

Scan to listen to Day 9

> *"The LORD is near to those who have a broken heart, and saves those who have a crushed spirit."*
>
> **Psalm 34:18**

REFLECTION

This verse does not tell the brokenhearted to recover first and then come near. It says God comes near to them, in the condition they are in. A crushed spirit is not disqualifying; it is where he is said to be.

PRAYER

God, I do not have much left in me today, and I will not pretend otherwise. Come near the way this verse says You do, to the broken and the crushed, and carry what I cannot.

DECLARE

Being broken does not put me out of God's reach.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Tell one safe person one true sentence about how you are doing. If despair has become heavy or constant, reach out today to a pastor, counselor, or doctor; the people listed under Steady me now are there at any hour.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Waiting for Morning

Scan to listen to Day 10

> *"I wait for the LORD. My soul waits. I hope in his word. My soul longs for the Lord more than watchmen long for the morning, more than watchmen for the morning."*
>
> **Psalm 130:5–6**

REFLECTION

A watchman on the wall cannot make the sun rise. He can only stay at his post and keep looking east. The psalmist's waiting is like that: not passive, not in control, but awake and expecting.

PRAYER

Lord, the night feels long, and I cannot make the morning come. Teach me to wait like a watchman, awake, at my post, looking toward You. Give me Your word to hope in while I wait.

DECLARE

Morning is not up to me, and it is still coming.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Name one thing you are waiting on that you cannot hurry. Then name one small duty that is still yours today, and do just that one.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

When I Am Afraid

Scan to listen to Day 11

> *"When I am afraid, I will put my trust in you. In God, I praise his word. In God, I put my trust. I will not be afraid. What can flesh do to me?"*
>
> **Psalm 56:3–4**

REFLECTION

The psalm does not say "I am never afraid." It says "when I am afraid," and then names what it will do. Trust here is not the absence of fear; it is a decision made in its presence, sometimes many times a day.

PRAYER

God, I am afraid right now. I am not waiting to feel brave before I trust You. In this fear I put my trust in You, and when it rises again, I will put it there again.

DECLARE

Fear is the moment I choose trust, not proof that I lack it.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write verse 3 on something you will carry today. Each time fear rises, read it once and say, "Again."

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Every Tear

Scan to listen to Day 12

> *"You count my wanderings. You put my tears into your container. Aren't they in your book?"*
>
> **Psalm 56:8**

REFLECTION

Four verses after "when I am afraid," the same psalm pictures a God who keeps count: of wanderings, of tears, of nights you thought no one saw. Being seen does not end the pain, but it ends being alone in it.

PRAYER

Lord, You have kept count of what I could not keep track of. Thank You that my tears are not wasted or forgotten. Hold what I have cried over, and let me feel known in it.

DECLARE

None of my tears have gone unseen.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write down one sorrow you have carried quietly. Give it a date and one sentence, as though writing it in God's book. Then close the page.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Higher Than I

Scan to listen to Day 13

> *"From the end of the earth, I will call to you when my heart is overwhelmed. Lead me to the rock that is higher than I."*
>
> **Psalm 61:2**

REFLECTION

"Lead me to the rock that is higher than I" is the prayer of someone who knows their own footing is not enough. An overwhelmed heart does not have to climb on its own; it can ask to be led.

PRAYER

God, my heart is overwhelmed, and I cannot climb out of this by myself. Lead me to the rock that is higher than I am: higher than my fear, higher than my thinking, higher than this day.

DECLARE

I do not have to climb alone; I can ask to be led.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

When overwhelm rises today, stop and pray this verse as one sentence. Then do only the next small thing, and let the rest wait.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

My God, My God

Scan to listen to Day 14

> *"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Why are you so far from helping me, and from the words of my groaning?"*
>
> **Psalm 22:1**

REFLECTION

Jesus prayed this line from the cross (Matthew 27:46), so the feeling of being forsaken is not foreign to faith; it was spoken at its center. And the psalm does not end where it begins. By verse 24 it says God has not hidden his face from the afflicted, and when they cried to him, he heard.

PRAYER

My God, sometimes You feel far away, and I am not going to pretend You don't. I say it to You, the way Jesus did. Hear me in the distance I feel, and let me find, as this psalm does, that You were listening all along.

DECLARE

Feeling forsaken is not the same as being forsaken.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Read all of Psalm 22 once, slowly, and mark the verse where it begins to turn. Then note where you are in your own psalm today. You do not need to be at the end yet.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

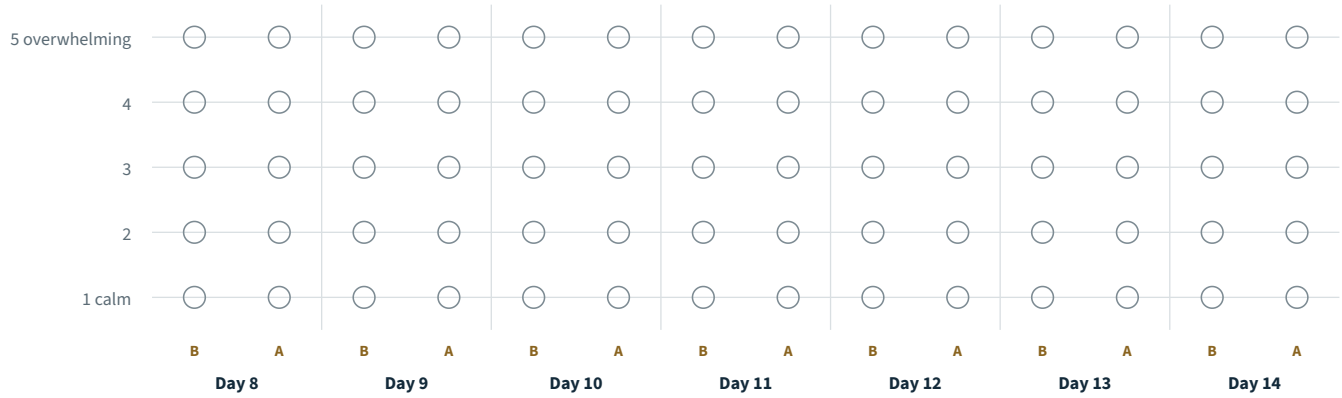
Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Looking back on week two

MY CHECK-INS, DAYS 8–14

For each day, fill the circle for your fear before (B) and after (A) you prayed.



THE DECLARATIONS

Circle the one you most want to keep.

- ○ **DAY 8** Asking God “how long” is still talking to God.
- ○ **DAY 9** Being broken does not put me out of God’s reach.
- ○ **DAY 10** Morning is not up to me, and it is still coming.
- ○ **DAY 11** Fear is the moment I choose trust, not proof that I lack it.
- ○ **DAY 12** None of my tears have gone unseen.
- ○ **DAY 13** I do not have to climb alone; I can ask to be led.
- ○ **DAY 14** Feeling forsaken is not the same as being forsaken.

What shifted this week, even a little?

Where was it hardest?

What do I want to bring into next week?

Date _____

Trust and Do Good

Scan to listen to Day 15

> *"Trust in the LORD, and do good. Dwell in the land, and enjoy safe pasture."*
>
> **Psalm 37:3**

REFLECTION

Psalm 37 is written to someone watching unfair things go well for other people. Its answer is not to stop noticing, but to keep three small habits: trust, do good, and stay put. Fretting rehearses what others are doing; trust returns attention to what is yours to do.

PRAYER

Lord, I have spent too much attention on what others are doing and what it might cost me. Bring my eyes back to what is mine: to trust You, to do the next good thing, and to stay where You have put me today.

DECLARE

My part is to trust and do good; the rest is God's.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Draw two columns, "theirs" and "mine." Sort every worry you have been rehearsing into one of them. Do one thing from "mine" today.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Be Still

Scan to listen to Day 16

> *"Be still, and know that I am God."*
>
> **Psalm 46:10**

REFLECTION

The psalm that opened with mountains falling into the sea closes with this. "Be still" is not advice to relax; some translations render it "cease striving." It means setting down the frantic effort to hold everything up, and remembering who God is.

PRAYER

God, I keep bracing as if everything depends on my holding it together. For this moment I stop. I am still, and I remember: You are God, and I am not. Let that be relief rather than reproach.

DECLARE

I can stop holding up the sky.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Set a timer for two minutes. Breathe in on "Be still," and out on "and know that I am God." Repeat until the timer ends.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

A Quieted Soul

Scan to listen to Day 17

> *"Surely I have stilled and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with his mother, like a weaned child is my soul within me."*
>
> **Psalm 131:2**

REFLECTION

A weaned child sits with its mother not to be fed but simply to be near. That is the picture of a soul that has stopped demanding answers before it will rest. The psalmist says he stilled and quieted it himself; quiet is practiced, not only received.

PRAYER

Lord, I have been demanding answers before I will rest. Quiet my soul the way a child is quieted beside a parent: not because everything is explained, but because You are near. I lay down the great matters that are too much for me.

DECLARE

I can rest without having all the answers.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write down one question about your situation that you cannot answer right now. Fold the paper, set it aside, and spend five minutes doing something quiet without returning to it.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Fully Known

Scan to listen to Day 18

> *"You know my sitting down and my rising up. You perceive my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down, and are acquainted with all my ways."*
>
> **Psalm 139:2–3**

REFLECTION

Fear often hides inside the thought that no one sees the whole picture. This psalm says Someone does: your sitting and rising, your path and your lying down, even your thoughts from afar. Being fully known can feel exposing at first; here it is meant as company.

PRAYER

Lord, You know my days and my nights, and the thoughts I would not say aloud. I do not have to explain myself to You or hide from You. Let being known by You feel like being kept.

DECLARE

I am fully known, and I am not abandoned.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Walk through your day in the psalm's four moments: sitting down, rising up, the path, lying down. At each, pause and say, "You know this one too."

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Cast Your Burden

Scan to listen to Day 19

> *"Cast your burden on the LORD and he will sustain you."*
>
> **Psalm 55:22**

REFLECTION

Psalm 55 was written by someone hurt by a person who had been close (verses 12–14), not by a stranger. "Cast" is a strong word: not hand over politely, but throw. The promise is not that the burden vanishes, but that you will be sustained while it is carried.

PRAYER

God, I have been carrying this as if setting it down would be irresponsible. I cast it on You now: the weight, the worry, and the part I keep picking back up. Sustain me while You carry what I cannot.

DECLARE

I can set this down without giving up.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Name the burden in one sentence. Say it aloud, then open your hands as you pray verse 22. When you notice yourself picking it back up, open your hands again.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

My Times

Scan to listen to Day 20

> *"But I trust in you, the LORD. I said, "You are my God." My times are in your hand."*
>
> **Psalm 31:14–15**

REFLECTION

"My times are in your hand" covers the clock and the calendar: the delay, the appointment, the result that has not come. The psalmist does not know how his times will go; he knows whose hand they are in.

PRAYER

Lord, I want to know when: when this ends, when the answer comes, when I can breathe again. I do not get to know that today. So I say what the psalmist said: You are my God. My times are in Your hand.

DECLARE

I do not hold the calendar; God does.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write down the date you are most anxious about. Beside it write "in Your hand." Each time that date comes to mind today, repeat the phrase once.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

A Steady Heart

Scan to listen to Day 21

> *"He will not be afraid of evil news. His heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD."*
>
> **Psalm 112:7**

REFLECTION

This verse does not promise that hard news will never come. It describes a heart steady enough not to be ruled by waiting for it. A heart like that is built over weeks like this one, one practiced trust at a time.

PRAYER

God, I brace every time my phone lights up. Make my heart steady, fixed on You and not on the next message. When hard news does come, let it find me trusting, not already undone.

DECLARE

My heart can be steady before the news arrives.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Look back over this week's practices and choose the one that steadied you most. Decide when you will use it the next time fear rises.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

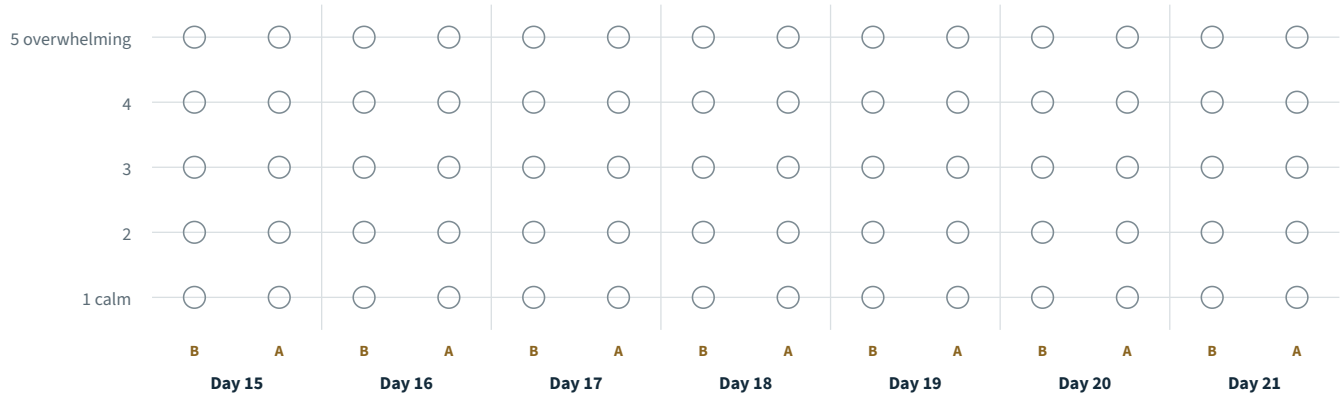
Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Looking back on week three

MY CHECK-INS, DAYS 15–21

For each day, fill the circle for your fear before (B) and after (A) you prayed.



THE DECLARATIONS

Circle the one you most want to keep.

- ○ **DAY 15** My part is to trust and do good; the rest is God's.
- ○ **DAY 16** I can stop holding up the sky.
- ○ **DAY 17** I can rest without having all the answers.
- ○ **DAY 18** I am fully known, and I am not abandoned.
- ○ **DAY 19** I can set this down without giving up.
- ○ **DAY 20** I do not hold the calendar; God does.
- ○ **DAY 21** My heart can be steady before the news arrives.

What shifted this week, even a little?

Where was it hardest?

What do I want to bring into next week?

Date _____

Delivered

Scan to listen to Day 22

> *"I sought the LORD, and he answered me, and delivered me from all my fears."*
>
> **Psalm 34:4**

REFLECTION

This week turns from asking to telling. David is looking back: he sought, God answered, and he was delivered from all his fears, not all his circumstances. Some fears are answered by a changed situation; many are answered by a steadier heart inside the same one.

PRAYER

Lord, I have been seeking You these past weeks, some days barely. Thank You for the fears You have already loosened, even the ones I did not notice leaving. Keep answering, and help me be honest about what is still here.

DECLARE

God answers, even when the answer is a steadier me.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Look at a fear you named in the first week. Write one sentence about what has changed since then, and one about what has not.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Forget Not

Scan to listen to Day 23

> *"Praise the LORD, my soul, and don't forget all his benefits."*
>
> **Psalm 103:2**

REFLECTION

David commands his own soul not to forget, because forgetting is the default. Fear keeps a long memory for threats and a short one for help. Gratitude is not pretending things are fine; it is keeping an accurate record.

PRAYER

Lord, my memory holds on to every danger and lets go of every rescue. Today I tell my soul to remember. Bring back to mind the help I have already been given, so that fear is not the only one keeping records.

DECLARE

I will keep an honest record, including the help.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

List ten specific kindnesses from the last month, as small as a meal or a kind word. Read the list aloud, slowly.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Morning

Scan to listen to Day 24

> *"In the morning I will lay my requests before you, and will watch expectantly."*
>
> **Psalm 5:3**

REFLECTION

"Watch expectantly" is what a person does after making a request they believe was heard. Bringing the day's needs to God first does not shrink the needs. It changes who you face them with.

PRAYER

Lord, in the morning I lay my requests before You: before the news, before the messages, before worry gets its say. Then help me watch for You through this day, expecting You to be at work.

DECLARE

Before fear speaks this morning, I speak to God.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Tomorrow, before you check your phone, lay out three requests for the day, one sentence each. In the evening, look back for any sign of God at work in them.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Remember

Scan to listen to Day 25

> *"I will remember your wonders of old. I will also meditate on all your work, and consider your doings."*
>
> **Psalm 77:11–12**

REFLECTION

Psalm 77 begins in sleepless distress (verses 2–4) and turns on one decision: I will remember. Memory here is not nostalgia; it is evidence. What God has done before becomes ground to stand on when you cannot yet see what he will do.

PRAYER

God, when I cannot see what You are doing now, help me remember what You have done before: in Scripture, in people I love, in my own life. Let those memories hold me up today.

DECLARE

What God has done before is ground I can stand on.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write down three times you were sure something would end badly and it did not, or it did and you were carried through. Keep the list with the names for God you wrote on Day 6.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

A Firm Place to Stand

Scan to listen to Day 26

> *"He brought me up also out of a horrible pit, out of the miry clay. He set my feet on a rock, and gave me a firm place to stand."*
>
> **Psalm 40:2**

REFLECTION

David was lifted out of a pit he could not climb, and only then set on a rock and given a firm place to stand. Standing comes after the lifting: the ground is given before it is held.

PRAYER

Lord, You have lifted me out of places I could not climb out of alone. Set my feet on rock, and give me a firm place to stand today. Let my footing be Your doing, so I do not have to hold it up myself.

DECLARE

My firm place to stand is a gift, not an achievement.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Write a short before-and-after of one pit you have been brought out of, even partly. Note the people God used to help lift you.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Tell the Next Generation

Scan to listen to Day 27

> *"We will not hide them from their children, telling to the generation to come the praises of the LORD, his strength, and his wondrous deeds that he has done."*
>
> **Psalm 78:4**

REFLECTION

The psalm treats children as the people who most need to hear what God has done. Children notice fear in the adults around them. They can also notice faith: calm words, honest prayers, a story of being carried.

PRAYER

Lord, the children around me notice more than I say. Let them see not an adult without fear, but one who brings fear to You. Give me simple, true words to tell them what You have done.

DECLARE

My faith can be part of the story the next generation hears.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Tell one child or young person a short, age-appropriate story of a time God helped you. Keep it hopeful, and keep adult worries out of it. If no child is near, write the story down for one who may read it later.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

Sown in Tears

Scan to listen to Day 28

> *"Those who sow in tears will reap in joy. He who goes out weeping, carrying seed for sowing, will certainly come again with joy, carrying his sheaves."*
>
> **Psalm 126:5–6**

REFLECTION

The farmer in this psalm is weeping and sowing at the same time. Grief does not have to end before faithful work begins; the seed can go into the ground wet. The harvest is promised to the one who kept carrying the seed.

PRAYER

Lord, some of what I am doing right now I am doing in tears. Let it count as sowing. Keep me carrying the seed, and let me see, in Your time, the joy this psalm promises.

DECLARE

What I sow in tears is not wasted.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Name one faithful thing you are doing while still grieving. Do it again today, and call it sowing.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Date _____

He Heard Me

Scan to listen to Day 29

> *"I love the LORD, because he listens to my voice, and my cries for mercy. Because he has turned his ear to me, therefore I will call on him as long as I live."*
>
> **Psalm 116:1–2**

REFLECTION

The psalmist's love grows out of being heard. Over these weeks you have cried, waited, questioned, and remembered. Whatever has and has not changed, the ear has been turned toward you the whole time.

PRAYER

Lord, I love You because You listen. You have heard my cries for mercy these weeks, the spoken ones and the ones I only felt. Because You have turned Your ear to me, I will keep calling on You as long as I live.

DECLARE

I have been heard, and I will keep calling.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Read back through your notes from this journey. Mark one place where you can now see you were heard, and thank God for it by name.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

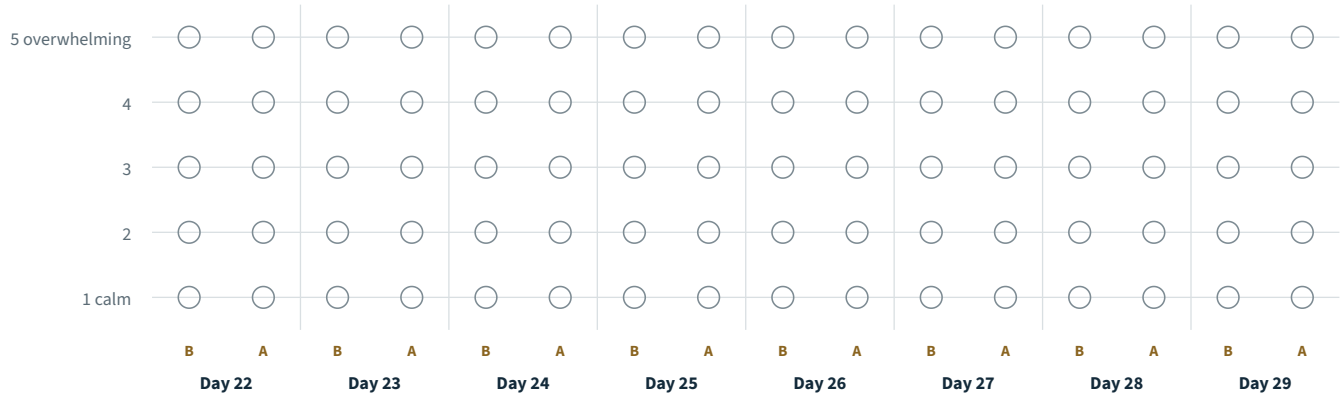
Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Looking back on week four

MY CHECK-INS, DAYS 22–29

For each day, fill the circle for your fear before (B) and after (A) you prayed.



THE DECLARATIONS

Circle the one you most want to keep.

- ○ **DAY 22** God answers, even when the answer is a steadier me.
- ○ **DAY 23** I will keep an honest record, including the help.
- ○ **DAY 24** Before fear speaks this morning, I speak to God.
- ○ **DAY 25** What God has done before is ground I can stand on.
- ○ **DAY 26** My firm place to stand is a gift, not an achievement.
- ○ **DAY 27** My faith can be part of the story the next generation hears.
- ○ **DAY 28** What I sow in tears is not wasted.
- ○ **DAY 29** I have been heard, and I will keep calling.

What shifted this week, even a little?

Where was it hardest?

What do I want to bring into next week?

Date _____

I Shall Not Be Moved

Scan to listen to Day 30

> *"I have set the LORD always before me. Because he is at my right hand, I shall not be moved. Therefore my heart is glad, and my tongue rejoices. My body shall also dwell in safety."*
>
> **Psalm 16:8–9**

REFLECTION

The steadiness here is a practice, not a personality: "I have set the LORD always before me." What keeps the psalmist from being moved is where he keeps his attention, and who is at his right hand. This journey began with dwelling in the shelter of the Most High, and it ends with the same word: dwell in safety.

PRAYER

Lord, I set You before me today, and tomorrow, and on the days fear returns. Be at my right hand. Let my heart be glad and my body rest in safety, not because nothing around me can move, but because You do not.

DECLARE

Fear may come again; I know where to stand and where to rest.

☐ SAID ALOUD

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Choose one psalm from these thirty days to keep as your own, and write it where you will see it daily. Decide what you will turn to when fear returns: that psalm, the Steady me now pause, or a person you trust.

☐ DONE

FEAR CHECK-IN Before I prayed (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) After (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) 1 = calm · 5 = overwhelming

What is fear telling me today? What is true instead?

Where did I notice help today, from God or from someone?

One thing I want to carry into tomorrow

Looking back on thirty days

Read what you wrote before Day 1. What do you notice now?

What has changed, in me or around me?

Which declaration will I keep?

What comes next?

WHERE TO GO FROM HERE

In the Stand app: Stand (30 days) · Fear of the Unknown (5 days) · Night Fear & Sleep (5 days) · 17 four-day courage stories, from the furnace to the barley field · the Prayer Book and the Rosary · Steady me now, any time. Or begin these thirty days again; the second time through often reads differently.

NOTES

NOTES

ABOUT

About this workbook

Stand is a free prayer companion for fear, with no account, no advertising and no tracking. Every day in this workbook is also in the app, where it can be read aloud: **prayers.dougdevitre.org**.

SCRIPTURE

Scripture quotations are from the World English Bible, which is in the public domain.

WHAT STAND IS, AND ISN'T

Stand offers spiritual encouragement and prayer. It is not medical, mental health, legal or financial advice, and it is not a substitute for a licensed professional. If you need help now, the numbers are on page 3.

USING THIS WORKBOOK

The text and prayers in Stand belong to the Stand project. You are welcome to print this workbook for your own personal, non-commercial prayer, and to share the link with anyone.

THIS EDITION

First printed edition, October 2026. The devotional text is a draft awaiting review by a pastoral advisor; later editions will follow that review.

If fear feels bigger than you can carry right now, you don't have to carry it alone:

- **988** — Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text, 24/7)
- Text **HOME** to **741741** — Crisis Text Line
- **1-800-799-7233** — National Domestic Violence Hotline (24/7; or text START to 88788)
- **1-800-422-4453** — Childhelp National Child Abuse Hotline (call or text, 24/7)
- **911** — if you are in immediate physical danger
- Outside the US: **findahelpline.com** — free, verified helplines in 175+ countries

Stand offers spiritual encouragement. It isn't medical or crisis care, and reaching out for more help is its own act of courage.